

Race Odds Scraper – Setup Guide (Windows)

This scraper fetches race odds data from <https://www.odds.com.au/horse-racing/> and saves it into a CSV file and running at a specified time daily. You can install it easily using our PowerShell script or set it up manually.

Option 1: Automatic Setup (Recommended)

Requirements

- Windows 10/11
 - Python
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Steps to Use the Auto Setup Script

1. Download the Project Files

- Clone the repo or download it as ZIP and extract to a folder, e.g., `C:\RaceOddsScraper`

2. Open PowerShell as Administrator

- Right-click the Start menu → **Windows PowerShell (Admin)**

3. Run the Setup Script

```
cd "C:\RaceOddsScraper"
```

- Allow script execution if needed:

```
Set-ExecutionPolicy -ExecutionPolicy RemoteSigned -Scope Process
```

- Run the setup script:

```
.\setup_bot.ps1
```

4. Follow the Prompts

- o Enter the time to schedule the bot (e.g., 14:00)
 - o The script will:
 - Create a virtual environment
 - Install required dependencies
 - Schedule the task to run daily
 - Ensure only one instance runs at a time
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Option 2: Manual Setup

Step 1: Install Python

- Download from [python.org/downloads](https://www.python.org/downloads/) (<https://www.python.org/downloads/>)
 - During install, **check the box: "Add Python to PATH"**
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Step 2: Set Up the Project

1. Open PowerShell

2. Navigate to the project folder:

```
cd "C:\RaceOddsScraper"
```

3. Create a Virtual Environment

```
python -m venv venv
```

4. Install Dependencies

```
.\venv\Scripts\pip install -r requirements.txt
```

5. Install Playwright browser dependencies

```
.\venv\Scripts\playwright.exe install
```

Step 3: Configure Environment Variables

Create a file named `.env` in the project folder with the following:

```
OUTPUT_DIR="C:/Users/username/Documents/Output"  
SCRAPE_INTERVAL=5
```

Step 4: Test the Scraper

```
.\venv\Scripts\python.exe main.py
```

Step 5: Schedule the Task Manually

1. Open **Task Scheduler**

2. Click **"Create Task"**

3. Under **General Tab**:

- Name: RaceOddsScraper
- Run with highest privileges
- Configure for Windows 10 or later

4. **Trigger Tab**:

- Add a new Daily trigger at desired time

5. **Action Tab**:

- Program/script: C:\RaceOddsScraper\venv\Scripts\python.exe
- Add arguments: "C:\RaceOddsScraper\main.py"
- Start in: C:\RaceOddsScraper

6. **Settings Tab**:

- Check **"If the task is already running, stop the existing instance"**
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Logs

- Logs are saved in `logs` folder in the project folder.
 - To reschedule or remove the task, open **Task Scheduler > Task Library**.
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